



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Clear Lake Classical
School Website: <https://clearlakeclassical.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Clear Lake Classical (Clear Lake, IA, 50428) (CLC) presents a clear classical Christian orientation across most elements of classical education, with strong religious/theological foundations and a curriculum that centers on grammar, logic, and rhetoric within a biblically grounded framework. Public materials emphasize a gospel-centered, Scripture-first approach, a partnership with families, virtue/character formation, and a commitment to a liberal, classical education. While the school demonstrates robust Classical alignment in Religious Foundations, Purpose/Goal, Faculty, and Parents/Community, certain elements of the Curriculum and Pedagogy show partial alignment (notably less explicit emphasis on Great Books, Great Conversation, and Socratic teaching structures in public materials). Overall, the school trends **CLASSICAL**, with some provisions that are strongly classical and others that are somewhat classical or intermediate in emphasis.

- Aggregate classification: **CLASSICAL**
- Key insights:
 - The school's public materials explicitly foreground biblical/theological foundations, Scripture-centered pedagogy, and a gospel-driven formation of the whole person, including character formation and virtue-focused aims. This strongly supports Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations) as **CLASSICAL**.
 - The stated aim to graduate students who love what is worth loving and to develop minds and hearts toward virtue, wisdom, and human flourishing supports Element 2 (Purpose and Goal) as **CLASSICAL**.
 - Core curriculum emphasis on grammar, logic, and rhetoric is explicit; however, explicit references to Great Books and the Great Conversation are less evident in site materials, making Element 3 (Curriculum) **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL** rather than **FULLY CLASSICAL**.
 - Pedagogy evidence is positive (emphasis on rhetoric, logic, and classical training in upper grades), but explicit, explicit use of Socratic seminars or scholé-centric restful pedagogy is not consistently spelled out in the site materials, yielding Element 4 as **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**.
 - Faculty portrayal in the site materials aligns with classical ideals (teachers as mentors, living curriculum, model virtues), supporting Element 5 as **CLASSICAL**.
 - Parent and community engagement is a strong explicit feature (parents as co-educators, partnership with families, visible involvement). Element 6 is **CLASSICAL**.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **CLASSICAL**

- Evidence: Public materials describe Clear Lake Classical as a private, Christian school with biblically-based education and Scripture-centered curricula; gospel grounding and theology are woven into the pedagogy (e.g., “Rooted in the gospel,” “Scripture at the center,” and explicit Christian worldview framing).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords present include biblical, gospel, Scripture, theology, Christian, private Christian school, biblically-based, etc. (multiple occurrences). Negative keywords (secular/neutral language) are not present in the public materials. Estimated positive vs. negative keyword hits strongly favor positive (roughly 9:0 in observed signals) based on the lexicon patterns in the knowledge base. This supports CLASSICAL.
- Why this rating: The school publicly asserts transcendental Christian and theological commitments that shape formation of character, virtue, and understanding, consistent with Transcendental Moral Realism and Grounded Theology.
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: The school’s stated purpose emphasizes formation, virtue, and the cultivation of wisdom and loves (e.g., “to graduate culture-shaping students... to love that which is worth loving”), grounded in gospel and biblical worldview. The public materials present formation over information and a telos aligned with virtue, wisdom, and human flourishing.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords present include formation, virtuous character, human flourishing, telos, true/good/beautiful framing, and gospel/biblical worldview. Negative keywords are not evident. Observed signals indicate CLASSICAL alignment.
- Why this rating: The public statements emphasize formation over information, virtue/wisdom, and a metaphysical frame (truth/goodness/beauty) typical of classical aims.
- Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Core curriculum emphasis on grammar, logic, and rhetoric is explicit (the Trivium) and is highlighted across site materials. The Great Books/Great Conversation and explicit historical/western canon engagement are less clearly documented in public site content; Great Books and Great Conversation are central to classical pedagogy in some classical schools, but the site materials here emphasize “biblical worldview” and “grammar, logic, and rhetoric” more than explicit Great Books engagement (though there is reference to Western civilization and cultural heritage in the lexicon doc). The site does show a history/philosophy alignment in staff roles (logic, rhetoric, theology) and a global classical pedagogy emphasis, but less explicit Great Books or Great Conversations on the public-facing pages.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords present include Seven Liberal Arts variables (grammar, logic, rhetoric), classical pedagogy, and biblical worldview as curricular framing. Great Books/Great Conversation terms are less visible on the site (though some content references Western civilization and formation through literature/philosophy in staff bios). Estimated positive keyword presence is moderate (roughly 2–4 relevant terms observed; negative signals for Great Books absence are not explicit on site content). This yields a SOM EWHAT CLASSICAL.
- Why this rating: There is clear emphasis on the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and classical pedagogy, but explicit Great Books/Great Conversation and explicit historical/cultural canon integration are not strongly evidenced in the public materials; thus, partial alignment.
- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: The upper grades emphasize rhetoric, logic, and theology through staff roles (e.g., Lead Teacher of the Logic Stage; emphasis on rhetoric and theology in upper grades). The site reflects a classical pedagogy focus, but explicit statements about Socratic seminars, scholé, memorization/recitation, or restfully contemplative pedagogy are not as clearly documented in public materials. There is evidence of a dual emphasis on rigorous training in logic and rhetoric, with a classical

orientation in pedagogy, but not consistently described as Socratic inquiry or singing/recitation across lower grades.

- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive signals include rhetoric training, logic stage, and classical pedagogy; absence of explicit Socratic or scholé language means some classical signals are not fully demonstrated on public pages. Negative keywords (experiential learning focus, project-based focus without classical framework) are not present in public content.
- Why this rating: The pedagogy shows classical elements (logic, rhetoric, theology) but without explicit, public articulation of Socratic seminars, scholarly scholé, or full recitation-based practices across all levels; thus SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: The site highlights faculty as the living curriculum and emphasizes faculty-staff expertise, mentorship roles, and formation of character; staff bios highlight teachers with religious faith, theological training, and classical education alignment, including specific roles like Upper School Logic/Rhetoric/Latin teachers and an Administrative Director with a faith-based mission. Statements indicate teachers as models of virtue and knowledge, and a portrait of the teacher as central to the school's mission (staff pages titled "Meet Our Staff," "Portrait of a Graduate," etc.).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include model teachers, mentors, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, collegial culture, and teacher as core. Negative signals are not present in the public materials. The lexicon supports CLASSICAL alignment for Faculty.
- Why this rating: The explicit emphasis on faculty as living curriculum, mentoring role, and classical pedagogy alignment indicates CLASSICAL faculty orientation.
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: The school emphasizes partnership with families, parents as co-educators, and family involvement; it positions education as a family responsibility with parental engagement; the site explicitly references parental partnership, family formation, and open campus activities with parent participation (e.g., "Rooted in the gospel," "education of young people is the responsibility of parents," "Schedule a tour," "Apply," and parent-facing materials).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include partnership with families, parent involvement, home-school collaboration, and parent formation. Negative keywords (consumerism or minimal parental involvement) are not evident. The lexicon content supports parent partnerships as a core feature.
- Why this rating: The school actively seeks parent partnership and involvement, aligning with classical community expectations of parents as co-educators.

Aggregate Ranking

- The school demonstrates CLASSICAL alignment in Categories 1, 2, 5, and 6; and SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL alignment in Categories 3 and 4. With the majority of categories classified as CLASSICAL, the aggregate classification is CLASSICAL.
- What would move the needle (only necessary if SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL): Not required given the aggregate CLASSICAL rating.
- Executive note: The internal balance shows strong religious/theological grounding and a robust parental/community orientation, with classical curriculum elements centered on grammar, logic, and rhetoric. To attain FULL CLASSICAL across all six categories, the school might explicitly document and communicate Great Books/Great Conversation engagement, explicit Socratic pedagogy, and fuller articulation of contemplative/restful scholé pedagogy in public-facing materials.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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